

LEFT HAND STRADDLES

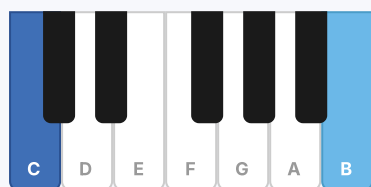
The left hand intervals that define your chord's harmonic identity — from the bass up.

Never octaves — they sound amateur and create no harmonic information. Use these straddles instead. Each one tells a specific harmonic story.

THE FOUR STRADDLE OPTIONS

ROOT + 7 — THE CORE STRADDLE

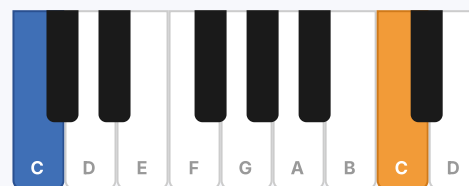
Cmaj7 — interval of a major 7th. Most common in jazz and neo-soul.



Works on all 7th chords. The 7th quality (major/minor/dominant) defines the chord. Clean, open sound.

ROOT + 9 — WARMTH & OPENNESS

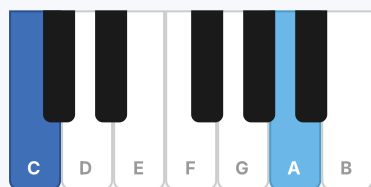
C¹ or Cm7 — interval of a major 9th (octave + whole step).



The 9th is actually the 2nd an octave up. Works beautifully on dominant and minor chords. Adds warmth.

ROOT + 6 — CLASSIC SOUND

C¹ — interval of a major 6th. Complete, settled feeling.



Classic, complete sound — heard in jazz standards everywhere. The 6th is the 13th an octave lower. Bright and resolved.

ROOT + 5 + 7 — FULLER SOUND

C¹aj7 — add the 5th (G) or a three-note left hand voicing.



1 + 5 + 7 or 1 + 5 + 9. Fuller texture for when you want a more complete sound in the left hand.

THE CORE PRINCIPLE

The **Root + 7th** (or 9th) is the essential straddle — it defines the chord quality and establishes the harmonic foundation. The 5th is optional: include it for fullness, drop it for space. The ear hears the outer interval (Root to 7 or Root to 9) as the defining sound. Master these four options and you have complete left hand vocabulary for any 7th chord progression.